

inhalations and saline nasal sprays can ease congestion, and hot honey drinks help soothe a sore throat.

Flu If you get the flu during pregnancy, call your doctor. Drink lots of liquids and get plenty of rest. Don't take any flu or medications without talking to your doctor first. Flu complications can include dehydration and pneumonia and are more common in pregnant women. The US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) recommends that all pregnant women get flu vaccinations. However, the nasal-spray flu vaccine is not approved for pregnant women.

Food poisoning and stomach upsets It's vital to practice good kitchen hygiene (see [Careful cooking](#)) to avoid getting food poisoning. If you do develop food poisoning or a stomach upset during pregnancy, try to drink plenty of fluids, and if it continues for more than 24 hours, see your doctor (see also [Gastroenteritis](#)).

Yeast If you have a thick, white discharge and itching inside or outside the vagina, it is likely that you have yeast (candidiasis). This is common in pregnancy and nothing to be concerned about, but since the itching can be intense, it is worth a trip to your doctor. A swab may be taken to confirm the diagnosis, and an appropriate local [antifungal treatment](#) prescribed. Eating plain yogurt may help restore the bacterial balance in your vagina. Wearing cotton underwear and avoiding tight clothing is also recommended.

Urinary-tract infections (UTIs) Many pregnant women get UTIs because the hormone progesterone relaxes all the smooth muscle, allowing the bacteria that normally live in your vagina to travel up the urethra (the tube that leads to the bladder) where they may cause an infection. The symptoms may be slightly different in pregnancy. Classic symptoms include burning when urinating and frequent urination; back pain, lower abdominal pain, nausea, or vomiting. These are usually easily treated with antibiotics, most of which are safe in pregnancy.

COVID-19 While there is still a lot of research to be done regarding the effects of COVID-19 in pregnancy and the virus is rapidly evolving, pregnant women are at increased risk of complications from infection. The best way to protect yourself, and your baby, from COVID-19 infection is to get vaccinated. If you test positive for COVID-19 during pregnancy, discuss your symptoms with your doctor. Current treatments including monoclonal antibodies and antiviral medications can be used in pregnancy and may be offered to you.

EXPOSURE TO CHICKENPOX OR RUBELLA

Chickenpox in pregnancy can be severe, possibly leading to pneumonia, and can cause problems both for you and for your baby. If you contract rubella for the first time in early pregnancy, it can cause miscarriage or severe problems in the fetus.

If you encounter chickenpox, contact your doctor who can check your immunity. If you aren't immune, your doctor may advise an injection to protect you from severe chickenpox.

Your rubella status is checked at the start of pregnancy. If you aren't immune, you can be vaccinated after the birth. Meanwhile you need to be extra careful.

If you develop chickenpox or suspect rubella because of a rash, contact your doctor immediately, but don't go to the doctor's office, where you may spread the infection to other pregnant women.

TAKING MEDICATIONS DURING PREGNANCY
